

The Sleeping Garden

The Floating Isles are islands adrift in a calm sky, in a realm where magic only ever helps: it grows, it heals, it changes one thing into another, and it lets you speak with animals and objects. It never harms. On the home island, the House of the Little Mages sits at the highest point, where young mages learn their first spells, and the city where the families live spreads below. Inside the school grounds lies the Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island. Here nobody loses; you find your way by being clever and kind.



The Sleeping Garden

A magical adventure map

How to use the map

- Put a small figure on each white circle (that is you).
- The golden path leads you from 1 to 4, solving each puzzle.

Build the objects from bricks.

START

Begin here

1

The Vine Gate

2

The Flower Bed

3

The Talking Fountain



The Heart of the Garden
GOAL

The Sleeping Garden

The same adventure as the simple telling, with a little more room to breathe. Read it aloud, or let an older child read it themselves. The beats and the puzzles are identical; only the language has grown up.

Before you begin

This morning you wake to a silence so complete that it feels like a held breath. From the high window of the House of the Little Mages you look down over the home island, and your stomach tightens. The Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island, has turned grey and motionless, as though something has coaxed it into a deep sleep. The flowers are shut tight. The fountain, which usually murmurs all day, makes no sound at all.

You are two young mages, and this is your first real adventure. You shoulder your bag, glance at each other, and without quite planning to, you say the same words at the same moment: "Let us go and wake it up." Below you, the golden path winds away into the quiet.

Choose your mage name and your magic, Light, Grow, Change, or Voice, before you take the first step.

Stop 1: The Vine Gate

The path brings you to a tall gate, and your way is blocked. Over the seasons the vines have grown across it and pulled themselves into an enormous, stubborn knot of leaves, and the gate will not give so much as an inch.

Something stirs in the haze beside the path. A cat the colour of fog pads out and sits, curling its tail neatly around its paws. It is the Mist Cat, and everyone on the island knows it turns up exactly when a hint might be useful. It studies the knot, then turns its calm eyes to you, as if to say: well, what shall we do about this?

How do you open the way? You might coax a gap to grow, change the knot into something looser, or simply ask the vines, politely, to step aside. See what you can invent.

The moment the gate swings wide, a single sleepy flower unfurls one petal, as if testing whether morning has truly come. The garden is waking, just a little.

Stop 2: The Flower Bed

Beyond the gate lies a wide flower bed, and here something has gone gently wrong. Four flowers have drooped and forgotten where they belong, their colours muddled. As you draw near, a thread of a voice hums an old planting rhyme, the kind a gardener might teach a child: "First the sun, then the sea, then the berry, then fly free."

The flowers clearly want to stand in their proper order again. They have simply forgotten which colour comes where, and they are hoping you can work it out.

Each line of the rhyme is a clue to a colour. Which flower is the sun, which is the sea? Set the four of them in the order the rhyme sings, and see what happens.

As the last flower slips into place, all four lift their heads and open wide, turning their faces up to a sky that is slowly bluing. Two more corners of the garden shake off their grey.

Stop 3: The Talking Fountain

The path opens onto a wide stone fountain, and the first thing you notice is the silence. No splash, no trickle, not even a drip. The water lies flat and grey as an old coin, and somehow the whole fountain seems to droop, as if it has forgotten how to be glad. When you lean in to listen, it lets out a long, low sigh. It is not broken. It is only waiting for a reason to sing again.

How do you coax it back? A song, a joke, a few kind words? The fountain does not need fixing so much as cheering. What will you try?

At the first sign of real cheer the water leaps upward, catches the light, and breaks into a bright, splashing tune it had clearly been longing to sing. Now only the very heart of the garden remains asleep.

The Heart of the Garden

At the centre of the Great Garden, where the golden path finally ends, you find the cause of all of it: a small sprite, curled up as tight as a fist, with a face full of worry. This is the one who sent the garden to sleep. Not out of malice, you realise, and not as any kind of villain. It was simply lonely, so lonely that it did not know how to ask for company, and a sleeping garden was the only way it knew to keep anyone near.

There is nothing here to defeat. There never was.

What do you say to the sprite? How might you show it, in words or in a gesture, that it does not have to be alone any more?

When you offer your friendship, plainly and kindly, the sprite's worried face softens into the first smile it has worn in a very long time. And all at once the Great Garden wakes around you: petals spring open, the fountain sings, the Mist Cat stretches in a patch of new sunlight, and warmth pours back across the whole island.

You solved it the way every adventure on the Isles is solved, together, by being clever and by being kind. Well done, both of you.

The Story in Pictures



A tall gate tied shut with a knot of green vines, the Mist Cat watching nearby.



A flower bed of four big flowers in yellow, blue, red and white, slightly out of order.



A quiet stone fountain beginning to sparkle and flow again.



The garden's heart waking, the shy sprite smiling as two little mages offer friendship, flowers opening in golden light.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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